

ASMIT DATTA

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Software Engineer Intern, Summer 2027

PayPal

First, I would like to talk about how I approach problems, how I get better at them, and how I work in a team. I accept it when I fall short of understanding something, and I give my best to understand it from people better than me. I have a lot of respect for anyone I can learn from, and I am not ashamed to ask the same question twice if that is what it takes. It works the other way too. When someone is stuck on something I have already worked out, I will sit with them rather than hand over the answer, and I come out of those understanding it better than when I went in. Knowledge seems to be one of the few things that grows when you share it. I think about problems in systems, and I approach them that way. I also ask the questions that are uncomfortable - I have seen them frustrate people, but they are usually the ones that need asking. I know I have a lot left to learn.

I would encourage you to visit my portfolio at www.asmit.space.

I am a first-year M.S. Computer Science student at NYU, graduating in 2028, after a B.S. at Arizona State and three internships. At WatchDNA I set up the backend from scratch - the databases, JWT authentication with role-based access, and the security middleware around it - then stayed with it across nine months. Python is the language I reach for first: the endpoint-discovery pipeline behind that product's store locator, and the FastAPI backend of a lead pipeline that keeps five scouts running across Zillow, Redfin, FSBO, expired listings and county assessor records, deduplicating by address and scoring what it finds.

The work closest to what your team does is Torii. It sits between AI agents and the paid tools they call, enforcing identity, policy and budget on every request: JWT identity per agent, a policy engine, and a ledger recording every call and why any one was blocked. The payment flow runs end to end: intercept the HTTP 402, check the wallet, pay, retry. The part worth talking about is the budget tracker: it reserves funds before the upstream call, so two agents running at once cannot overspend the same balance. I did not set out to separate authorization from settlement; the concurrency problem made me. I would like to see how it is actually done, at a scale where getting it wrong matters.

I am available for the full summer from June 2027.